



NO. 7 OF 16

Charlie Ashby

THE SOCIETY COLUMNIST

“Everyone knows the silver fox. That is exactly the problem.”

FOR CHARLIE ASHBY'S EYES ONLY

CORE CHARACTER

BOOKLET · 4 PAGES

WHAT TO WEAR · PICK EITHER

SUIT STYLE

A grey suit, a fedora with a press card in the band, and a notebook.

MASK: Silver fox (or any silver mask)

DRESS STYLE

A grey drop-waist dress, a cloche hat, a press card and a notebook.

Keep this booklet closed until the party. Turn the page only when the Inspector tells everyone to read “Before the game”.

PAGE 2

Before the game: who you are and what you know.

PAGE 3

Rounds 1–3: read each one only when the Inspector says so.

PAGE 4

Your notes and the suspect quick list.

Before the game

You write “Harbor Lights”, the Gazette’s society column. Last Saturday you told your readers you would attend tonight as a silver fox, with a little sketch of the mask. Every guest knows who the fox is.

YOUR SECRET

In your pocket is a column for Monday’s paper: Gus is secretly selling the Blue Lantern to the Harbor Hotel Company, and the staff will lose their jobs. Gus found out at 10:00 and threatened to sue the Gazette. At 11:50 you slipped out to the lobby telephone booth to read the column to the night desk before midnight. Your mask fogged up, so you took it off in the booth.

You are innocent

From 11:51 to 11:59 you were in the lobby telephone booth, on the line to the Gazette. You hung up just after the lights went out.

HOW TO PLAY TONIGHT

- ◆ Read each round only when the Inspector starts it. Do what it says while you mingle.
- ◆ You may keep your secret until your booklet tells you to share it. You may not lie about anything printed on an evidence card.
- ◆ In Round 1, swap the rumour on your Rumor card with as many guests as you can.
- ◆ Stuck? Ask someone a question, or go and study the evidence table.

PLAYING CHARLIE

Your manner: Nosy, quick and delighted by scandal. Scribble in your notebook, and say “off the record, darling” whenever you want someone to tell you more.

Rounds 1–3

Round 1



Read only when the Inspector starts Round 1

Everyone will stare at you, because you are the fox. Be indignant: “I was nowhere near that tower!” But a good columnist protects a story, so don’t say where you were yet. Ask Dana exactly who took Gus’s glass from the tray.

Round 2



Read only when the Inspector starts Round 2

The telephone slip proves it: you were in the lobby booth from 11:51 to 11:59. Explain the column. Then make the point out loud: somebody else was wearing a silver fox mask at 11:55. Ask the room: who else knew what your mask looked like? (Anyone who read your column.)

Round 3



Read only when the Inspector starts Round 3

If pressed, read out the part of your column about the sale. Then ask the room who went shopping at Delacroix Theatrical Supply this month.

Notes & suspects

YOUR NOTES: WHO SEEMS NERVOUS? WHOSE STORY HAS CHANGED?

BEFORE YOU VOTE

At the end, everyone fills in a ballot: who, how and why, plus the clue that convinced you.

Suspect quick list (public information only)

NAME	ROLE	TALK OF THE PARTY
Remy Quill	The Art Dealer	Sold Gus the seascapes in his gallery
Avery Lark	The Resident Singer	Contract about to be cancelled by Gus
Jordan Pierce	The Club Partner	Would lose everything if the club was sold
Sidney Hart	Gus's Ward and Heir	Named in Gus's new will
Morgan Bellamy	Owner of The Gilded Owl	Gus's business rival
Frankie Dade	The Bandleader	Owes Gus a large sum of money
Charlie Ashby	The Society Columnist	Wore the silver fox mask; had a column about Gus
Dana Rook	The Caterer	In charge of the champagne tower
Leslie Croft	Gus's Lawyer	Knows exactly what the new will says
Billie Sable	The Coat-Check Attendant	Saw who came and went from the cloakroom
Robin Vale	The Aviator	Lost a fortune in Gus's air-mail company
Jesse Monroe	The Photographer	Took the 11:55 photograph
Kit Haverford	The Shipping Heir	Broke off an engagement to Gus
Taylor Moss	The Stage Magician	Knows how to make the lights go out
Emery Fontaine	The Dance Instructor	Not on the dance floor at 11:58
Marion Kettle	The Club Chef	Keeps the greenhouse key in the kitchen
Inspector Sloane Whitaker	The host	Running the investigation
Augustus "Gus" Whitlock	The victim	Owner of the Blue Lantern Club